CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

CHOCOLATIER / CANDY MAKER IN THE AI ERA

Robots can mold a candy bar. They still can't taste one.

★ **TL;DR — Handmade chocolate and candy at a ~$45K median, learnable in 1–6 months with no license gate. The catch: it's a craft you sell one box at a time — the making is the fun half, the selling is the job.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

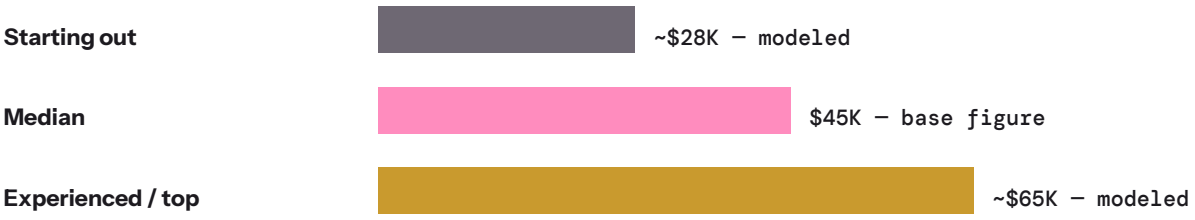
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$45K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Low AI risk: tempering, texture and taste are hands-and-palate work that machines don't replicate at small scale.
- The money follows the brand, not the bench — shops pay for reliable hands, owners keep the margin.
- Ingredient costs and holiday seasonality decide whether this is a business or an expensive hobby.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Chocolatier / Candy Maker is a ~$45K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A CHOCOLATIER / CANDY MAKER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Tempering chocolate and making ganache, centers and caramels
- ✓ Molding, dipping and decorating pieces to a consistent finish
- ✓ Packaging, labeling and keeping the display case stocked
- ✓ Cleaning equipment and managing ingredient inventory

Think: a pastry jeweler — tiny products, obsessive precision, everything judged in one bite.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Industrial lines already mold, wrap and sort commodity candy at scale, and software happily handles your labels, listings and ads. The factory end of candy is automated; the artisan end is not.	Taste. A human palate decides when the ganache is right, invents the flavor nobody asked for, and hands a customer a sample with a story attached. That sample is what sells the box.

⚠ **Chocolate is unforgiving: a humid day or a sloppy temper ruins a batch you already paid for. Waste and holiday dependence are built into the trade.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ A fragrant, quiet workshop instead of an office ✓ Work you can hold, gift and photograph ✓ A product people are genuinely happy to buy	✗ Long, repetitive stretches standing at a bench ✗ Early mornings and brutal holiday rushes ✗ Thin margins until your name means something

Good fit? Patient, precise and genuinely food-obsessed — and willing to sell your own work at markets and to shops.
Bad fit? You want predictable salaried income fast, or you hate repetitive detail work.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — WORK IN A CHOCOLATE SHOP OR BAKERY	DOOR B — START YOUR OWN SMALL BRAND

Start as a chocolatier's assistant or production hand. You learn tempering, costing and volume on someone else's ingredients, and you leave with a portfolio of products you can prove you can make.	Develop a tight line — a few bonbons, bars or caramels — and sell at farmers markets, pop-ups and local shops. Slower money, but every customer is yours and the margin stays with you.

Smart move: Master one signature product people re-order and gift. A famous truffle funds the experiments; a wide menu just funds your ingredient shelf.
Where you land after: Senior chocolatier, production lead, or owner of a small chocolate brand with wholesale accounts.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
SET UP	DRILL THE	BUILD A	TEST ON	GET PRODUCTION	SYSTEMIZE AND

STEP 1 — Set up a home bench

LOW COST · WEEK 1

- Get the core kit: a thermometer, molds, a cool work surface and good couverture chocolate
- Learn the science first — tempering curves and ganache ratios — from reputable pastry sources

STEP 2 — Drill the fundamentals

WEEKS 2-6

- Temper, mold bars and dip centers daily until your snap and shine are consistent
- Keep a batch log: temperatures, humidity, what failed and why

STEP 3 — Build a small line

MONTHS 2-3

- Nail a tight range: a truffle, a bar, a caramel, a seasonal piece
- Cost every recipe carefully so you know your real price before you sell

STEP 4 — Test on real customers

MONTHS 2-4

- Sell at a market stall, a pop-up or through a friendly café
- Track what sells out, what gets gifted and what gets ignored

STEP 5 — Get production work or accounts

MONTHS 3-5

- Apply to chocolate shops and bakeries with photos of your line
- Or pitch a few local shops on wholesale boxes

STEP 6 — Systemize and grow MONTHS 5-6

- Batch your production days and plan around quality, not speed
- Build your calendar around the holidays that carry candy sales

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: order a thermometer and couverture chocolate, and temper your first batch tonight.
- □ Days 1–30: daily tempering practice with a batch log; choose the product styles you'll master.
- □ Days 31–60: finalize a small line with honest costing; photograph everything.
- □ Days 61–90: first market stall or pop-up, and first conversations with local shops.
- □ Day 90: you're selling weekly and either hold a production job or your own small account list.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ TASTE CAN'T BE AUTOMATED. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.